PAKISTAN & THE WORLD

CSS VISTA

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ECONOMY / THE LEAD

Pakistan's October Inflation Eases to 9.6%

The latest consumer-price figures show a lower annual rate than September, while the price index still rose during October.

On Monday, 2 November 2026, Pakistan Bureau of Statistics reported October CPI inflation of 9.6% year on year, compared with 10.3% in September and 6.2% in October 2025. The index still rose 1.1% month on month.

Urban inflation was 9.5% and rural inflation 9.8%. Annual SPI inflation stood at 8.7% and wholesale inflation at 13.8%. A decline in annual inflation means slower price growth, not a fall in prices.

BACKGROUND

CPI compares a consumer basket over time; the annual rate and monthly movement answer different questions.

ANALYSIS

Lower annual inflation may ease policy pressure, but the positive monthly reading and wholesale inflation show that prices remain under strain.

THREE REVISION POINTS

01 National CPI 9.6% • 02 Urban 9.5% / Rural 9.8% • 03 WPI 13.8%

CSS ANGLE Current Affairs / Pakistan Affairs — inflation, monetary transmission and household welfare

SOURCES 01 · 02

AT A GLANCE

INFLATION

Consumer inflation slowed to 9.6% year on year in October; monthly prices still rose 1.1%.

DIPLOMACY

Ishaq Dar and Liu Haixing discussed closer Pakistan–China coordination in Islamabad.

REGIONAL FINANCE

Pakistan assumed the SCO Interbank Consortium chairmanship for 2026–27.

GLOBAL MARKETS

China's central bank injected 541 billion yuan at the 1.25% overnight reverse-repo rate.

GLOBAL HEALTH

WHO asked states to complete the PABS annex for the pandemic agreement.

01 Pakistan

12.00%	276.7219	166,564.06
SBP POLICY RATE · EFFECTIVE 27 OCT 27	USD/PKR · M2M REVALUATION · 2 NOV 27	KSE-100 CLOSE · 2 NOV 28

MARKET INDICATORS · PREVIOUS BUSINESS DAY OR LATEST POLICY DECISION

DIPLOMACY

Dar and Liu Haixing Renew Pakistan–China Coordination

The Islamabad meeting prioritised diplomatic continuity, cultural links and closer public exchanges.

On Monday, 2 November 2026, Deputy Prime Minister and Foreign Minister Ishaq Dar met Liu Haixing, head of the International Department of the Communist Party of China Central Committee, in Islamabad. According to Radio Pakistan, Dar reaffirmed Pakistan's commitment to the bilateral all-weather strategic cooperative partnership.

The two sides discussed expanding cultural cooperation and people-to-people exchanges and agreed to remain in close contact. Liu conveyed greetings from Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi. Dar sent greetings to President Xi Jinping on behalf of Pakistan's leadership.

The discussions were political and diplomatic in character. The released account did not announce a new treaty, financing package or completed project; its principal reported outcome was continued coordination.

BACKGROUND

The International Department of the Communist Party of China works on the party's international relationships. Visits involving the department can operate alongside normal government-to-government diplomacy.

ANALYSIS

Political links can support the broader relationship by sustaining communication between party institutions and governments. The important question is whether dialogue later translates into concrete economic, cultural and regional-policy initiatives.

THREE REVISION POINTS

— The visiting Chinese official was Liu Haixing.

— The meeting took place in Islamabad on 2 November 2026.

— The official account identified cultural and people-to-people ties as discussion areas.

CSS ANGLE International Relations — Pakistan–China partnership and multi-level diplomacy

SOURCES 03 · 04

REGIONAL FINANCE

Pakistan Takes SCO Interbank Consortium Chairmanship

The 2026–27 position places regional banking coordination at the centre of Pakistan's economic diplomacy.

On Monday, 2 November 2026, Pakistan announced that it had assumed the chairmanship of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation Interbank Consortium for 2026–27. Radio Pakistan said the Ministry of Finance intended to use the position to promote financial links among SCO members.

The consortium brings participating financial institutions together to facilitate cooperation on trade, investment and development financing. The announced priorities included cross-border investment, financial connectivity and regional economic integration.

The position relates to the SCO's interbank mechanism; it should not be confused with authority over every operation or decision of the organisation. Statements of policy intent should also be separated from completed investments or lending transactions.

BACKGROUND

The Shanghai Cooperation Organisation is a Eurasian regional grouping. Its Interbank Consortium is a mechanism involving member-country financial institutions rather than an independent central bank.

ANALYSIS

The opportunity for Pakistan is to move beyond meetings toward bankable projects and easier cross-border finance. Any outcome will depend on commercial feasibility, financial risk, regulation and relations among the participating states.

THREE REVISION POINTS

— SCO-IBC means Shanghai Cooperation Organisation Interbank Consortium.

— Pakistan's announced chairmanship covers 2026–27.

— The stated aims include trade, investment and financial connectivity.

CSS ANGLE International Relations / Economy — SCO institutions and regional economic integration

SOURCES 05 · 06

FINANCIAL GOVERNANCE

Aurangzeb Calls for Regulated Digital-Asset Innovation

The finance minister linked digital finance to economic efficiency while emphasising safeguards and supervision.

BACKGROUND

Tokenisation represents rights in an asset or security using a digital record. Its regulatory treatment depends on the applicable legal framework, custody arrangements, investor protection and financial-market rules.

On Monday, 2 November 2026, Finance Minister Muhammad Aurangzeb addressed a Pakistan Banks' Association dialogue on digital assets and the future of banking through a virtual connection. He argued that financial innovation should lower business costs, increase formal participation and support productive investment.

The minister referred to the Virtual Assets Act 2026 as a statutory framework and said effective implementation would require competent supervision and coordination among institutions. He also stated that the government was reviewing tokenisation of existing Eurobond debt.

That debt proposal remained at a preparatory stage: Aurangzeb said cabinet approval was awaited before a request for bids could be issued. A proposal to explore tokenisation is not equivalent to issuing tokenised government debt.

ANALYSIS

Regulation has to address financial integrity, consumer protection, operational resilience and investor confidence. Technology alone cannot correct weaknesses in public finance or banking supervision.

THREE REVISION POINTS

— The event was organised by the Pakistan Banks' Association.

— Aurangzeb referred to the Virtual Assets Act 2026.

— Tokenisation of existing Eurobond debt was under review, not completed.

CSS ANGLE Economy / Governance — fintech regulation, sovereign finance and financial inclusion

SOURCES 07

ENERGY / PUBLIC POLICY

Government Seeks Refinery Support to Contain Petrol Prices

Ministers said refineries would absorb an expected price increase and reported substantial fuel-relief registrations.

On Monday, 2 November 2026, Information Minister Attaullah Tarar and Petroleum Minister Ali Pervaiz Malik told a news conference in Islamabad that the government had sought help from domestic refineries to avoid passing an expected petrol-price increase to motorists.

Tarar said an increase of Rs15 per litre had been anticipated and that refineries would shoulder the additional cost. He also reported more than 15 million registrations under the Prime Minister's

The figures were ministerial claims at the announcement; they were not independently audited in the cited reports. The ministers linked the pressure on fuel prices to regional disruptions affecting energy supply routes.

BACKGROUND

Domestic retail fuel prices are sensitive to global petroleum prices, exchange rates, levies, taxes and distribution costs. Any arrangement that transfers costs to refineries can affect future investment and supply

Fuel Relief Scheme and said Rs27 billion in assistance had been provided.

incentives.

ANALYSIS

Price relief can cushion consumers temporarily, but policy evaluation must track who bears the cost, how benefits are targeted and whether refinery finances remain sustainable. The distributional effects matter as much as the headline pump price.

THREE REVISION POINTS

— The ministers cited a possible Rs15 per litre petrol increase.

— The claimed fuel-relief registrations exceeded 15 million.

— The reported disbursement was Rs27 billion, attributed to the minister.

CSS ANGLE Pakistan Affairs / Economy — energy pricing, targeted subsidies and fiscal trade-offs

SOURCES 08 · 09

ENVIRONMENT / PUBLIC HEALTH

Lahore Records Hazardous Morning Air Pollution

A monitoring snapshot placed Lahore's air-quality index above 530 as fine-particle concentrations surged.

On Monday, 2 November 2026, Lahore's air-quality index reached 535 at 8 a.m., according to IQAir figures reported by Dawn. The associated PM2.5 concentration was 343 micrograms per cubic metre. The index reading fell in the hazardous category.

Several other Punjab cities registered severe pollution during morning updates. In one ranking Gujranwala recorded an AQI of 606, while Faisalabad and Multan were reported at 310. The figures changed with time and monitoring location and should be understood as specific observations rather than daily citywide averages.

High PM2.5 exposures raise risks for respiratory and cardiovascular health. A durable response requires controls on combustion sources, cleaner transport and industry, better enforcement and consistent public reporting.

BACKGROUND

PM2.5 refers to airborne particles with aerodynamic diameters of 2.5 micrometres or less. AQI communicates pollution severity on an index scale; it is not a concentration in micrograms per cubic metre.

ANALYSIS

The 2 November readings illustrate the governance challenge of seasonal air pollution. Measurement accuracy, enforcement, provincial coordination and public-health communication are essential to evaluating interventions.

THREE REVISION POINTS

— Lahore AQI was 535 at 8 a.m. on 2 November.

— Lahore PM2.5 was reported at 343 µg/m³ in that snapshot.

— AQI and PM2.5 concentration are different measurements.

CSS ANGLE Environmental Science / Current Affairs — smog, particulate pollution and health policy

SOURCES 10 · 29

02 World

ASIA / MONETARY POLICY

China Shifts to Overnight Policy-Rate Operations

Beijing's central bank used large-scale overnight liquidity injections as it changed its operational rate anchor.

On Monday, 2 November 2026, the People's Bank of China injected 541 billion yuan into the banking system through overnight reverse repurchase agreements at 1.25 per cent, Reuters reported. The operation accompanied a formal shift toward the overnight rate as the central bank's main operational policy anchor.

The PBOC had earlier indicated that it would run overnight reverse repos daily while allowing seven-day reverse repo operations to use multiple rates. Analysts interpreted the change as a way to ease short-term funding conditions and support financial-system liquidity.

It was not a conventional announcement of a general benchmark interest-rate cut. The operational distinction matters when assessing how central banks transmit monetary conditions to banks and the wider economy.

BACKGROUND

Under a reverse repo, a central bank injects cash against securities with an agreement to reverse the transaction. The interest rate and maturity shape money-market liquidity and overnight funding conditions.

ANALYSIS

Changes in the operating framework affect bank funding costs, bond yields and financial confidence. Their effects on investment and consumption depend on the broader credit environment and economic expectations.

THREE REVISION POINTS

— The overnight injection was 541 billion yuan.

— The overnight reverse repo rate was 1.25%.

— The new anchor concerned operational money-market rates, not a simple conventional rate cut.

CSS ANGLE International Relations / Economy — central bank instruments and China's economic policy

SOURCES 11 · 12

MIDDLE EAST / ENERGY SECURITY

ADIPEC Warning Highlights Shrinking Global Oil Buffers

An ADNOC assessment linked disrupted sea routes with depleted inventories and higher delivery costs.

On Monday, 2 November 2026, ADNOC chief executive Sultan Al Jaber told the ADIPEC energy conference in Abu Dhabi that disruption around the Strait of Hormuz had drained nearly one billion barrels of crude oil from global inventories.

He said some markets were carrying diesel stocks at their lowest seasonal level in 35 years and others faced a 600-billion-cubic-foot liquefied-natural-gas supply gap. He also described logistics costs rising

BACKGROUND

Energy security normally involves adequate supply, affordable prices, infrastructure resilience and reliable routes to market. Maritime chokepoints such as the Strait of Hormuz can

from less than 5 per cent to more than 30 per cent of a barrel's cost.

These figures were presented as Al Jaber's assessment, not an independently validated global inventory census. His central policy argument was that energy security depends on reliable transportation routes and storage capacity as well as oil and gas production.

transmit regional disruptions to international prices.

ANALYSIS

Strategic reserves can offset temporary supply shocks, but depleted inventories reduce the margin for a further disruption. Import-dependent countries need diversified suppliers, resilient storage and transport arrangements.

THREE REVISION POINTS

— The ADIPEC remarks were delivered in Abu Dhabi on 2 November.

— The CEO estimated that nearly 1 billion barrels had been drawn from inventories.

— The Strait of Hormuz was central to the stated supply disruption.

CSS ANGLE Current Affairs / International Relations — energy geopolitics and maritime chokepoints

SOURCES 13 · 14

GLOBAL HEALTH GOVERNANCE

WHO Opens Renewed Pandemic-Agreement Negotiations

The ninth working-group meeting centred on the unfinished pathogen access and benefit-sharing annex.

BACKGROUND

Pathogen sharing gives public-health authorities and researchers access to biological information needed for surveillance and countermeasure development. Benefit-sharing debates focus on how countries and populations access resulting products.

On Monday, 2 November 2026, the World Health Organization opened the ninth meeting of the intergovernmental working group on the WHO Pandemic Agreement in Geneva. Director-General Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus urged states to finish the Pathogen Access and Benefit-Sharing annex, commonly called PABS.

Tedros said the agreement had already been adopted but that completing the annex remained necessary for the agreement's entry into force. The meeting's scheduled period was 2–13 November. The annex concerns arrangements linking pathogen sharing to fairer access to vaccines, diagnostics and other benefits.

The speeches described a negotiating objective rather than an agreement achieved on 2 November. They also made the broader case for international cooperation, early warning and more equitable access to medical countermeasures.

ANALYSIS

The unfinished annex tests whether international institutions can translate scientific cooperation into fair access during emergencies. The trade-offs involve public health, research capacity, sovereignty and financing.

THREE REVISION POINTS

— The WHO working-group meeting was its ninth.

— PABS stands for Pathogen Access and Benefit-Sharing.

— WHO scheduled the meeting for 2–13 November 2026.

CSS ANGLE Current Affairs / International Relations — international institutions and global health security

SOURCES 15 · 21

ENVIRONMENT / INTERNATIONAL LAW

UNEP Opens Week of Environmental-Law Meetings

An online programme began on strengthening laws dealing with climate, biodiversity and pollution.

On Monday, 2 November 2026, the United Nations Environment Programme began Environmental Law Week, scheduled to run online through 6 November. The programme brought together states, legal experts and stakeholders to exchange experience on environmental governance.

According to UNEP's official agenda, discussions took place under the fifth Montevideo Programme for the Development and Periodic Review of Environmental Law. The programme includes intergovernmental meetings and sessions on strengthening the environmental rule of law.

The meeting of national focal points was scheduled for 4–5 November within the same week. The agenda concerned legal capacity, implementation and coordination; the opening did not itself constitute the adoption of a new binding treaty.

BACKGROUND

Environmental rule of law combines meaningful legal duties with transparent institutions, enforcement and access to justice. The Montevideo Programme supports the development and implementation of environmental law.

ANALYSIS

International environmental commitments cannot deliver results without domestic institutions capable of enforcing them. Technical assistance and regulatory capacity are especially important where implementation gaps persist.

THREE REVISION POINTS

— UNEP Environmental Law Week ran 2–6 November 2026.

— The programme was organised online.

— It was linked to Montevideo Programme V.

CSS ANGLE Environmental Science / International Law — environmental governance and treaty implementation

SOURCES 17

SCIENCE / ONE HEALTH

WHO Reports First Confirmed Human Shamonda Infection

The case in France was previously reported to WHO; the new public notice described serious uncertainty over transmission.

On Monday, 2 November 2026, the World Health Organization published a disease-outbreak notice on the first documented laboratory-confirmed human Shamonda virus infection, involving an older immunocompromised patient in eastern France.

The patient developed severe neurological symptoms on 23 September and died on 8 October. France had notified WHO on 20 October. WHO stated that the

BACKGROUND

Shamonda virus had previously been identified principally in animals. One Health surveillance

infection was identified through sequencing and laboratory methods; no earlier human infection had been documented.

The source and route of transmission remained unknown, and WHO said the public-health risk could not yet be reliably assessed. Possible vector-borne transmission was being investigated. The public release on 2 November, not the earlier illness, placed the story in the reporting window.

connects human, animal and environmental health investigations when a pathogen may cross between species.

ANALYSIS

A single documented infection does not establish sustained human transmission. Sound outbreak reporting distinguishes a laboratory-confirmed case from speculation about transmission, prevalence and population risk.

THREE REVISION POINTS

— WHO's public disease notice was dated 2 November 2026.

— The patient died on 8 October; France notified WHO on 20 October.

— WHO did not yet have enough evidence to assess the public-health risk reliably.

CSS ANGLE General Science & Ability / Environmental Science — zoonoses, surveillance and One Health

SOURCES 16

NEXT SEVEN DAYS

03 NOV United States federal general election

The Federal Election Commission lists 3 November as the 2026 general election date. Source

03–05 NOV WHO Emergency Medical Teams Global Meeting

Addis Ababa hosts a meeting on preparedness, response and the EMT 2030 strategy. Source

04 NOV WHO webinar on arboviral disease guidelines

Public briefing addresses clinical management of dengue, chikungunya, Zika and yellow fever. Source

09 NOV COP31 climate conference opens

The UNFCCC conference begins in Antalya, Türkiye; its announced run is 9–20 November. Source

03 General Knowledge

VERIFIED FACT FILE

01 ECONOMY

National October 2026 CPI inflation: 9.6% year on year. 01

02 ECONOMY

The corresponding September 2026 CPI inflation rate: 10.3%. 01

03 ECONOMY

National CPI increased 1.1% month on month in October 2026. 01

04 ECONOMY

October 2026 urban CPI inflation: 9.5% year on year. 01

05 ECONOMY

October 2026 rural CPI inflation: 9.8% year on year. 01

06 ECONOMY

October 2026 Wholesale Price Index inflation: 13.8% year on year. 01

07 DIPLOMACY

Liu Haixing led the Chinese party department delegation in the 2 November meeting. 03

08 DIPLOMACY

Ishaq Dar served as Pakistan's deputy prime minister and foreign minister at the meeting. 03

09 REGIONAL AFFAIRS

Pakistan assumed the SCO Interbank Consortium chair for 2026–27. 05

10 FINANCIAL LAW

Aurangzeb referred to the Virtual Assets Act 2026 in his 2 November address. 07

11 ENERGY

Ministers cited a potential Rs15-per-litre petrol-price increase. 09

12 PUBLIC POLICY

The government reported more than 15 million fuel-relief registrations. 09

13 ENVIRONMENT

Lahore's AQI stood at 535 at 8 a.m. on 2 November. 10

14 MONETARY POLICY

The PBOC injected 541 billion yuan via overnight reverse repos. 11

15 MONETARY POLICY

The PBOC's overnight reverse-repo rate was 1.25%. 11

16 HEALTH LAW

WHO's ninth pandemic-agreement working-group meeting opened on 2 November. 15

17 GLOBAL HEALTH

WHO's 2 November notice described the first laboratory-confirmed human Shamonda virus case. 16

18 INTERNATIONAL LAW

UNEP Environmental Law Week was scheduled for 2–6 November, online. 17

19 ENERGY SECURITY

The ADNOC chief estimated nearly one billion barrels drawn from crude inventories. 13

04 Five Terms

CONSTITUTION AND POLITICAL SCIENCE

Judicial review

Judicial review is a court's authority to assess whether government action is consistent with superior law, including a constitution. It can result in an unlawful act being set aside.

WHY IT MATTERS It is central to constitutional limits, separation of powers and accountability.

EXAMPLE United States, 1803: Marbury v. Madison is a standard historical example of the judiciary declaring an incompatible law invalid.

Authoritative source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AND DIPLOMACY

Diplomatic immunity

Diplomatic immunity protects accredited diplomats from specified forms of the receiving state's jurisdiction so they can discharge official functions. It is governed by legal privileges and duties, not a general right to act unlawfully.

WHY IT MATTERS It helps explain diplomatic relations, reciprocity and the balance between state sovereignty and international cooperation.

EXAMPLE Vienna, 18 April 1961: the Vienna Convention on Diplomatic Relations codified central rules on diplomatic privileges and immunities.

Authoritative source

ECONOMY AND PUBLIC FINANCE

Primary fiscal balance

The primary fiscal balance is the government budget balance after excluding net interest payments. A primary surplus means non-interest public revenue exceeds non-interest expenditure, under the applicable statistical definition.

WHY IT MATTERS It separates current fiscal choices from the interest burden of accumulated debt and is used in debt-sustainability analysis.

EXAMPLE IMF and World Bank, 2018: their guidance for low-income-country debt-sustainability analysis uses projections of primary fiscal balances.

Authoritative source

LAW, GOVERNANCE AND ADMINISTRATION

Ombudsman

An ombudsman receives and investigates grievances about maladministration in the public sector within a legally defined mandate. The office provides an accessible route to administrative accountability outside ordinary litigation.

WHY IT MATTERS The institution illustrates citizens' remedies, due process and administrative oversight.

EXAMPLE Pakistan, 24 January 1983: the Establishment of the Office of Wafaqi Mohtasib (Ombudsman) Order created the federal ombudsman institution.

Authoritative source

ENVIRONMENT AND PAKISTAN AFFAIRS

Environmental impact assessment

Environmental impact assessment is an advance examination of the probable environmental consequences of a proposed activity. Authorities use it to consider environmental effects before development decisions are finalised.

WHY IT MATTERS It connects sustainable development to evidence-based planning and preventive regulation.

EXAMPLE Rio de Janeiro, June 1992: Principle 17 of the Rio Declaration called for environmental impact assessment of proposals likely to cause significant adverse effects.

Authoritative source

05 Practice

15 QUESTIONS · FOUR OPTIONS · ONE BEST ANSWER

01. Which October 2026 CPI figure was released by Pakistan Bureau of Statistics on 2 November?

A. 7.9%
B. 8.6%
C. 9.6%
D. 10.3%

02. Which comparison accurately describes October inflation?

A. Annual rate lower than September; monthly prices still increased
B. Annual rate higher than September; monthly prices fell
C. Annual rate and monthly index both fell
D. Annual rate unchanged; monthly prices increased

03. Which pairing matches the official October 2026 CPI breakdown?

A. Urban 9.8%; rural 9.5%
B. Urban 9.5%; rural 9.8%
C. Urban 8.7%; rural 13.8%
D. Urban 10.3%; rural 6.2%

04. Which institution's representative met Ishaq Dar in Islamabad on 2 November?

A. UN General Assembly Secretariat
B. Asian Development Bank
C. European External Action Service
D. International Department of the CPC Central Committee

05. Pakistan's 2026–27 regional banking role concerns which institution?

A. SAARC Development Fund
B. SCO Interbank Consortium
C. Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank board
D. Economic Cooperation Organisation Secretariat

06. What was the status of Pakistan's proposed Eurobond tokenisation on 2 November?

A. Completed and trading worldwide
B. Cancelled by the finance ministry
C. Under review; cabinet approval still awaited
D. Approved and already offered through bids

07. According to government ministers, what petrol-price increase were refineries asked to absorb?

A. Rs5 per litre
B. Rs10 per litre
C. Rs20 per litre
D. Rs15 per litre

08. What did the 8 a.m. Lahore AQI observation on 2 November report?

A. 535
B. 235
C. 343
D. 606

09. Which amount did the PBOC inject via overnight reverse repos on 2 November?

A. 154 billion yuan
B. 414 billion yuan
C. 541 billion yuan

D. 641 billion yuan

10. Which reading best characterises the PBOC's policy adjustment?

A. A fixed deposit guarantee was abolished
B. All lending rates were cut by one point
C. Capital controls were immediately lifted
D. Its operating rate anchor moved to overnight operations

11. Which global energy risk was emphasised at ADIPEC?

A. Narrower supply buffers and higher shipping costs
B. A worldwide statutory ban on LNG imports
C. The permanent closure of all oil refineries
D. The abolition of maritime oil shipping insurance

12. Which part of the WHO Pandemic Agreement remained unfinished in the 2 November remarks?

A. The WHO Constitution
B. The PABS annex
C. The International Court statute
D. The Paris Agreement schedule

13. Which fact about Shamonda virus was confirmed in WHO's notice?

A. Human-to-human transmission was widespread
B. The infection was transmitted exclusively by food
C. A first laboratory-confirmed human case was described
D. The global risk had been definitively graded low

14. Which of these best defines a primary fiscal balance?

A. Government balance excluding net interest payments
B. Government balance before all tax revenue
C. Exports minus imports of goods only
D. Cash in the central bank's vaults

15. Which 1992 Rio Declaration principle concerns environmental impact assessment?

A. Principle 6
B. Principle 9
C. Principle 12
D. Principle 17

Answer Key

EXPLANATIONS AND SOURCES

01 C The PBS monthly review recorded year-on-year national CPI inflation at 9.6%. Source

02 A The annual rate declined from 10.3% to 9.6%, while the index rose 1.1% month on month. Source

03 B PBS listed urban inflation at 9.5% and rural inflation at 9.8%. Source

04 D Liu Haixing headed the International Department of the CPC Central Committee. Source

05 B The announced chairmanship was of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation Interbank Consortium. Source

06 C The finance minister said tokenisation was under consideration before cabinet approval and any request for bids. Source

07 D Ministerial remarks referred to an expected Rs15 per litre increase. Source

08 A Dawn cited IQAir's 8 a.m. Lahore AQI of 535; 343 was a PM2.5 concentration. Source

09 C Reuters reported 541 billion yuan of overnight reverse repos. Source

10 D The change shifted the money-market policy anchor to overnight reverse-repo operations. Source

11 A The ADNOC CEO described shrinking inventory buffers and more expensive logistics. Source

12 B WHO's director-general urged negotiators to complete the Pathogen Access and Benefit-Sharing annex. Source

13 C WHO reported a first laboratory-confirmed human case and stated that transmission and public risk remained uncertain. Source

14 A The World Bank glossary defines the primary balance net of interest expenses and receipts. Source

15 D Principle 17 provides for environmental impact assessment for projects likely to cause significant adverse effects. Source

06 References

01 Pakistan Bureau of Statistics — Monthly Review of Price Indices, October 2026

02 Dawn · 2 Nov 2026 — Consumer inflation falls to 9.6%

03 Radio Pakistan · 2 Nov 2026 — Dar and Liu Haixing discuss Pakistan–China ties

04 Dawn · 2 Nov 2026 — Pakistan–China bilateral diplomatic report

05 Radio Pakistan · 2 Nov 2026 — Pakistan assumes SCO Interbank Consortium chairmanship

06 Dawn · 2 Nov 2026 — SCO Interbank Consortium financial cooperation

07 Radio Pakistan · 2 Nov 2026 — Finance minister addresses digital assets dialogue

08 Dawn · 2 Nov 2026 — Oil refineries to absorb fuel-price pressure

09 Radio Pakistan · 2 Nov 2026 — Government reports fuel relief figures

10 Dawn · 2 Nov 2026 — Lahore air pollution reaches hazardous level

11 Reuters · 2 Nov 2026 — PBOC shifts rate anchor and provides overnight liquidity

12 The Edge Singapore · 2 Nov 2026 — China overnight reverse repo policy anchor

13 Emirates News Agency · 2 Nov 2026 — ADIPEC remarks on global energy security

14 Reuters · 2 Nov 2026 — Energy inventories and the Strait of Hormuz

15 World Health Organization · 2 Nov 2026 — Opening remarks at ninth IGWG pandemic-agreement meeting

16 WHO · 2 Nov 2026 — Shamonda virus in human — France

17 UN Environment Programme · Nov 2026 — Environmental Law Week: 2–6 November

18 UNFCCC — COP31 Antalya, 9–20 November 2026

19 WHO — Emergency Medical Teams Global Meeting, 3–5 November

20 US Federal Election Commission — US general election date: 3 November 2026

21 WHO — Events calendar: arboviral guidance webinar, 4 November

22 US Courts — Judicial review and the Supreme Court

23 United Nations · International Law — Vienna Convention on Diplomatic Relations (1961)

24 World Bank — Debt Sustainability Framework: primary balance glossary

25 Pakistan Wafaqi Mohtasib — History of the federal ombudsman: established 24 January 1983

26 Convention on Biological Diversity / UNCED — Rio Declaration (1992), Principle 17

27 State Bank of Pakistan — Official policy rate and USD/PKR revaluation rate

28 Mettis Global · 2 Nov 2026 — KSE-100 closes at 166,564.06

29 The Express Tribune · 2 Nov 2026 — Lahore AQI 535; Punjab EPA confirmation